



Learn about data phases and tools

Hey. It's great to have you back.

We've talked a little bit about
the data analysis process.

As a quick refresher,
the data analysis process phases
are ask, prepare, process,
analyze, share, and act.

You might remember me saying earlier
that this entire program is modeled after these steps.

Now, we're going to really dig in
and explore how each of these phases work together.

But I'm getting a little ahead of myself.

First, let's spend a little time
understanding the data life cycle.

No, data isn't actually alive,
but it does have a life cycle.

How do data analysts
bring data to life?

Well, it starts with the right data analysis tool.

These include spreadsheets, databases,
query languages, and visualization software.

Don't worry if you don't know how these work,
or even what they are.

At one point, every data analyst
has been right where you are right now,
and they probably had a lot of the same questions.

I remember when I first started
learning about spreadsheets.

I was a young intern,
and the company I was working for
was in the middle of a big systems change.

That meant, we had to move tons of
reports from the old system to the new one.

After a few weeks,
I noticed that even the people
who were further in their careers
were not as technically minded as I was.

That became a great opportunity for me to add value.

My aha spreadsheet moment
came when I started researching shortcuts
that I could use to work with
the spreadsheets more efficiently.

This would really streamline the process of
getting those reports moved over to the new system.

Once everything started flowing,
I remember getting emails from
other finance analysts at the company.

They were so grateful
that someone had come in
and fixed a problem that no one else could.
That inspired me to go even further
and learn how to use spreadsheets
in all sorts of incredible ways.
As you continue through this course,
I bet you'll be just as impressed as I was.
And before you know it, you'll bring data
to life too. Let's get started.